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LANTERN FESTIVAL AND INTERNATIONAL WOMEN'S DAY CELEBRATION HELD AT BAHAY TSINOY MUSEUM

MANILA, Philippines — The Lantern Festival and International Women's Day celebration was successfully held on March 6 at the Bahay Tsinoy Museum in Manila through the auspices of the Embassy of the People's Republic of China in the Philippines. The event brought together guests and foreign delegates to celebrate Chinese culture while honoring the important role of women in society. The program began with a guided tour of the Bahay Tsinoy Museum, conducted in two batches for the participants. Bahay Tsinoy, known as the Museum of Chinese in Philippine Life, showcases the rich history, culture, and contributions of the Chinese community in the Philippines. Its exhibits trace the presence of the Chinese in the country from the pre-Spanish period, through the Galleon Trade era, the American and Japanese occupations, and up to the present time. According to Teresita Ang-See, founding chairman of the Move- ➔ (TURN TO PAGE 2)



APCU OPENS NOMINATIONS FOR THE 6TH AWARD FOR PROMOTING PHILIPPINES-CHINA UNDERSTANDING (APPCU) 2026



MANILA, Philippines — The Association for Philippines-China Understanding (APCU) has officially opened nominations for the 6th Award for Promoting Philippines-China Understanding (APPCU) 2026 during a launch held Friday at the Federation of Filipino Chinese Chambers of Commerce and Industry, Inc. (FFCCCII) in Binondo, Manila. During a press conference, APCU Chairman and President Raul Lambino announced that the 2026 edition marks the sixth staging of the APPCU Awards, organized in coordination with the Embassy of the People's Republic of China in the Philippines. Lambino expressed gratitude to the Federation of Filipino Chinese Chambers of Commerce and Industry, Inc. (FFCCCII) for allowing the use of its venue for the event. The APPCU Awards were first organized in 2020 ➔ (TURN TO PAGE 2)

DOST SOCCSKSARGEN, Kilambay Plantation Champion Sustainable Bamboo Industry at the Bamboo Technology and Innovation Summit 2026



The Department of Science and Technology hosted the Bamboo Technology and Innovation Summit 2026 on March 4 to 5, 2026 in Cebu City. The summit gathered key stakeholders to strengthen bamboo as a strategic resource for sustainable development and green industrial growth in the Philippines. ➔ (TURN TO PAGE 3)

LANTERN FESTIVAL AND
INTERNATIONAL WOMEN’S
DAY CELEBRATION... FROM PAGE 1



ment for Restoration of Peace and Order, around 60 foreign delegates attended the celebration. Ang-See also expressed gratitude to Francisco “Isko” Moreno Domagoso, Mayor of Manila, for allowing the use of the Bahay Tsinoy Museum as the venue for the event. The celebration featured various displays of traditional Chinese clothing and novelty items. Several books highlighting Chinese heritage and history were also exhibited and made available to visitors, including Live the Dream, Tsinoy: The Story of the Chinese in Philippine Life, Chinese in the Philippines, Dr. Jose Rizal’s Chinese Ancestry, and The Philippines in Ancient Chinese Maps. A cultural performance featuring the Chinese

folk song “Start of the Joy Season” was presented using a traditional Chinese musical instrument similar to a harp. Guests also watched a video presentation of Chinese Kung Fu integrated with robotics technology. Another highlight of the program was a presentation promoting the Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation (APEC) 2026, shown through China Central Television (CCTV), featuring segments titled “Gather in Shenzhen” and “Amazing Shenzhen.” The event concluded with a tribute to women in celebration of International Women’s Day, carrying the message that “Women Hold Up Half the Sky,” emphasizing the vital role of women in society and nation-building.

APCU OPENS
NOMINATIONS FOR
THE 6TH AWARD...
FROM PAGE 1



through the initiative of former Education Secretary Alejandro Roces and former President Gloria Macapagal-Arroyo, who now serves as Representative of Pampanga. According to Lambino, the awards aim to recognize Filipinos who have made significant contributions in promoting friendship, cooperation, and mutual understanding between the Philippines and China. He emphasized the importance of strengthening people-to-people relations between the two countries through education, cultural exchanges, business cooperation, and other collaborative initiatives. Lambino also expressed confidence in the Department of Foreign Affairs (DFA), led by Secretary Teresa Lazaro, in maintaining diplomatic relations between the Philippines and China despite ongoing issues in the West Philippine Sea. The APPCU Awards recognize individuals in

five categories who have helped foster better understanding and cooperation between the two nations. The awards ceremony is tentatively scheduled for mid-June 2026, depending on the availability of the venue. Meanwhile, APCU Director Mafee Cai said nominations may be submitted through the organization’s official website, apcu.org.ph, or via email. She added that all Filipinos are encouraged to nominate individuals who have contributed to strengthening Philippines-China relations. Director Brian James Lu urged nominators to clearly explain how their nominees have helped promote better understanding between the two countries. Also present during the launch were APCU Vice Chairman Sixto Benedicto and Directors Joaquin Sy and Dr. Lily Tan Lim, who encouraged the public to participate in the nomination process for the 6th APPCU Awards.

FFCCCII Launches TikTok
Video Competition to Show-
case Legacy of 6,500 Rural
Public-School Donations



MANILA, PHILIPPINES — The Federation of Filipino Chinese Chambers of Commerce and Industry, Inc. (FFCCCII) is calling on all creative Filipinos to join its newest digital initiative: a TikTok video competition aimed at highlighting the organization’s long-standing commitment to education through its "Operation Barrio Schools" project. FFCCCII President Victor Lim announced the launch of the competition, which is open to the general public. The contest invites participants to create engaging and original short-form videos (1 to 2 minutes) centered on the theme of the FFCCCII’s flagship civic project, which has successfully donated and constructed over 6,500 rural public-school buildings across the Philippines since its inception in 1961. "Operation Barrio Schools is a testament to the enduring philanthropy tradition of the Filipino Chinese community in promoting better public education and in-

clusive national economic development," said President Victor Lim. "Through this TikTok competition, we hope to engage the younger generation, raise awareness about this decades-long project, and showcase how this school buildings have become symbols of hope and progress in rural communities." The FFCCCII, a leading business federation comprising over 170 Filipino Chinese chambers of commerce nationwide, remains dedicated to advocating for sustainable and inclusive economic growth. This video competition serves as a modern platform to bridge the organization's history of philanthropy with the dynamic creativity of today's digital storytellers. How to Join: Interested participants are encouraged to create TikTok videos that capture the spirit and impact of the "Operation Barrio Schools" project. Details regarding specific mechanics, prizes, and deadlines are explained in next pages.

Cavite
Wisdom
Publishing
Kaalaman at Katotohanan para sa Bayan

CAVITE WISDOM PUBLISHING IS
PUBLISHED WEEKLY EVERY MONDAY

OFFICE ADDRESS:
B18 L14 Ph10 Oxygen St. Dasma 4 Golden City Barangay Salawag,
Dasmariñas City, Cavite 4114 Philippines Cel # 09176275522
Email Ad: wisdom.cavite@gmail.com
Fb Page: Wisdom Newspaper
Website: cavitewisdom.com

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**DOST SOCCSKSARGEN,
Kilambay Plantation
Champion Sustainable
Bamboo... From page 1**



DOST SOCCSKSARGEN Regional Director Engr. Sammy P. Malawan and Provincial Director Dr. Michael T. Mayo attended the summit and joined discussions on advancing bamboo technologies, sustainable plantation development, and value chain expansion. From Carmen, North Cotabato, Mr. Jerry John Taray, Chief Executive Officer of Kilambay Plantation Corporation, served as a guest plenary speaker. He presented the topic “Growing the Future: Sustainable Plantation Models for a Resilient Bamboo Industry.” During his presentation, Mr. Taray highlighted the Free, Prior, and Informed Consent or FPIC model adopted by Kilambay Plantation Corporation. This model ensures Indigenous Peoples and local communities hold the right to provide consent before projects utilize land and natural resources within their ancestral domains. The approach

strengthens community participation, protects indigenous rights, and promotes responsible plantation development. Mr. Taray also shared the milestone achieved by Kilambay Plantation Corporation in partnership with DOST. The collaboration significantly contributed to a Guinness World Record recognition through a large-scale bamboo initiative, which demonstrated the country’s strong potential to develop bamboo as a major driver for sustainable industry and climate responsive development. Through science-based innovations, technology transfer, and partnerships with communities, industry, and local governments, DOST promotes bamboo as a key resource in the circular economy. These efforts support sustainable production, efficient resource use, green livelihood opportunities, and climate responsive development for communities.

**DOST SOCCSKSAR-
GEN Joins Preparatory
Meeting for NSTW 2026**



As the next host of the National Science and Technology Week 2026, the Department of Science and Technology SOCCSKSARGEN joined the preparatory meeting held on March 6, 2026 at the DOST Main Building, Bicutan, Taguig City. The meeting was led by Undersecretary for Regional Operations Engr. Sancho A. Mabborang and Host Region Regional Director Engr. Sammy P. Malawan to begin key planning activities for the national event. Discussions focused on updates on the prepara-

tions for NSTW 2026, presentation of proposals, review of the Special Orders for the NSTW 2026 Steering Committee, and the proposed monthly schedule of committee meetings to ensure the smooth and coordinated implementation of the event. The meeting marked an important step in mobilizing the organizing teams as SOCCSKSARGEN gears up to host one of the country’s biggest celebrations of science, technology, and innovation (STI).

oOo

SHOWBLITZ
By: Charlene Mae
**Vice, naloka na napag-
kamalang munisipyo
ang Malacañang!**



Totoo namang naka-
kaloka ang isang con-
testant ng It’s Show-
time na hindi alam ang
Malacañang Palace.
Imagine, na-
pagkamalan ng nasa-
bing contestant ng
Laro Laro Pick sa It’s
Giving round na mu-
nicipal hall ang picture
ng Malacañang Palace.
Naunang ipinaliwanag
ng host na ang mga
bagay o konseptong
ipapakita nila ay may
kaugnayan sa Pilipi-
nas at sa kultura nito.
Ilang kala-
hok na ang natanggal
matapos hindi nila
makilala ang mga lar-
awan na nagpapakita
ta ng arnis, Bulkang
Mayon, luksong tinik
at tulay ng San Juan-
ico. Pagkatapos ay
ipinakita ang Palasyo
ng Malacañang sa
isa sa mga kalahok,
na hindi rin sumagot.
Naloka si Vice
Ganda: “Hindi mo

nakikita ‘yang lar-
awan na ‘yan? D’yan
namamalagi ang pan-
gulo. San namamala-
gi ang Pangulo?”
Sumagot
ang contestant: “Ay,
ano. Munisipyo?”
“Mala—” pag-
bibigayng hintni Jhong
Hilario sa contestant.
Pero waley pa rin.
Kaya nagpa-di-
alogue na si Vice ng
“Minsan naiisip ko,
‘yun bang tinuro sa
amin sa school dati,
tinuturo pa rin ngayon?
Kasi sa grade school
‘di ba tinuturo ‘yang
mga ganyan? Hindi
ko alam kung iba na
‘yung curriculum.”
Sabay talak
na may halong kon-
ti biro: “Malacañang
‘yan ha? Huwag puro
blush on saka high-
lighter sa TikTok ha?”
Susmio, oo
nga naman. Hin-
di alam ang hitsu-
Ganda: “Hindi mo
ra ng Malacañang.



SPORTS NEWS

Bossing binangga ng Road Warriors



MANILA, Philip-pines — Nangusan ng NLEX ang Blackwater, 84-81, para sa mabilis na arangkada ng kampanya nito sa PBA Season 50 Commissioner’s Cup kahapon sa Ninoy Aquino Stadium sa Maynila.

Bumalik was ang Road Warriors mula sa 16-puntos na pagkakatabak sa likod ng superstar guard na si Robert Bolick matapos itong pumukol ng game-high na 24 puntos. Nagdagdag pa ito ng 3 rebounds, 7 assists at 4 steals para sa kumpletong performance

sa kabila ng maalat na simula ng NLEX. Umakbay sa kanya ang import na si Cady Lanne na humakot ng 22 puntos at 16 rebounds na double-double sahog pa ang 2 tapal para sa magilas na PBA debut bilang isa bagong import ng liga. Nag-ambag naman ng 10 puntos si Schonny Winston sa kanyang unang salang sa NLEX matapos ma-trade mula sa Converge, habang may tig-6 puntos sina Kevin Alas at Xyrus Torres.

Malamya ang umpisa ng mga bataan ni coach Jong Uichico sa maagang 10-puntos

na deficit at naiwan pa sa hanggang 17-33 bago ang halftime.

Subalit karanasan ang ipinamalas nina Bolick at ng buong Road Warriors nang kumaripas sa second half hanggang sa masikwat ang 81-75 abante sa huling minuto tungo sa tagumpay.

Kumamada ng 18 puntos si Sedrick Barefield at may 16 puntos ang import na si Daniel Ochefu para sa Bossing. Tanging si Christian David na may 12 puntos lang ang nakatulong sa mga manok ni head coach Jeff Cariaso.

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CANCER

DIABETES

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PROLAPSE

ANEMIA

ARTHRITIS

ASTHMA

HEPATITIS

LEUKEMIA

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